Locust and mouse plagues

Mice and locusts are common **pests** on Australian farms. They take advantage of the extra food that farms provide, eating the pasture, crops and grains. Both animals can breed very quickly and reach **plague numbers** within months if conditions are favourable.

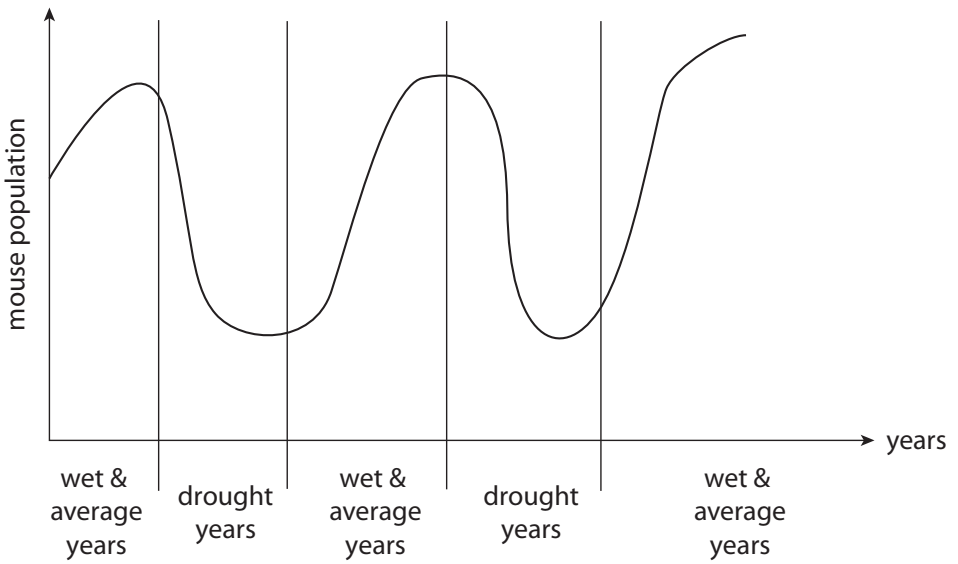
☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the food chains for these two Australian pests.

s_____	b_____
↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by
m_____	l_____
↑ eaten by	↑ eaten by
g_____ and g_____	any green s_____

Word bank

grass
mouse
grain
snake
bird
locust
shoots

Study the graph below, then answer the questions.



2 In drought years, mouse numbers _____.

3 In wet years after drought, mouse numbers _____.

4 Why do the numbers rise so quickly? _____

_____

5 Predict what might happen to bird and snake numbers during mouse or locust plagues.

_____

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